

Asus ROG Flow Z13 (2025)

Gaming revolution in tablet form



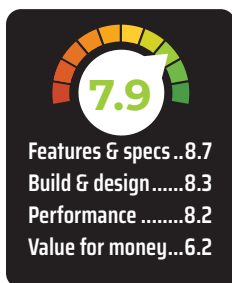
The ASUS ROG Flow Z13 is back, and this time, it's not just trying to be a flashy Windows gaming tablet. Powered by AMD's new Ryzen AI Max 390 chip, this year's Z13 might just be the most compact, power-efficient, and deceptively powerful gaming machine on the market. That's a big claim, considering it weighs under 1.2kg and has no fans on the GPU side.

So what happens when you stuff RTX 4060-level performance into something smaller than a MacBook Air? Is it really the future of gaming or just another expensive tech flex? Let's dive in.

DESIGN & BUILD

The ROG Flow Z13 continues ASUS's tradition of blending PC performance with tablet portability. It still looks like a tech enthusiast's fever dream—transparent back elements, magnesium build, and a kickstand that can handle any couch or blanket you throw at it.

It's light enough to carry everywhere, and the detachable keyboard snaps on with strong magnets, though the typing experience does suffer due to the lack of



solid support. The touchpad is functional but less responsive than what you'd want. Bonus points for easy SSD upgradability, just unscrew and you're in.

Port selection is solid too: USB-A on the right, HDMI and two USB-C (40Gbps) on the left, but no Thunderbolt 5 on the tablet itself. Ironically, the latest XG Mobile eGPU does support it, which creates a bit of a performance mismatch.

You can actually game on your lap, bed, or bean bag, thanks to the cooling vents placed away from the base. You won't block airflow, and it won't burn your legs. The front 1440p webcam is serviceable, but a bit grainy. The rear 4K cam with EIS is much better, great for creators or hybrid work scenarios.

Physical buttons include power, volume, and a shortcut to ASUS's multi-display software. Nice touch.

DISPLAY & AUDIO TESTS

The 13.4-inch WQXGA display is better than expected for a gaming tablet. With 518 nits of peak brightness and near 99% sRGB + 95% DCI-P3 coverage, this thing isn't just for gamers, it's a legit creative

tool. Colour accuracy is top-tier (ΔE ~1.5), and the 180Hz refresh rate with dynamic scaling extends battery life.

The dual-speaker setup is decent, but not impressive. The volume is fine for close use, but won't cut through louder environments, especially when the fans kick in. You'll need headphones.

PERFORMANCE

Let's get straight into the meat of it. The ROG Flow Z13, powered by the AMD Ryzen AI Max 390, delivers benchmark numbers that are genuinely impressive given its compact tablet form factor. In Cinebench R23, it scored 1,958 in the single-core test and 23,106 in the multicore benchmark. That puts it ahead of machines running on the Intel Core i7-14650HX and i7-13700HX, which scored 1,872 and 1,741 in single-core, and 20,560 and 16,981 in multicore, respectively. However, it trails the Intel Core Ultra 9 275HX and Core i9-13950HX, which pull ahead with scores crossing 33,000 and 28,000 in multicore.

But numbers alone don't tell the full story, thermals and power draw matter, especially for a tablet. Under stress testing, the Ryzen AI Max 390 held an average CPU package temperature of just 80°C. That's cooler than the 14650HX's 85°C, and nearly on par with the 13650HX in the Aorus 16. The thermal performance becomes even more impressive when you consider the total power draw: just 70W. In comparison, gaming laptops with discrete RTX 4060 GPUs consume more than double that, around 170W for the Lenovo Legion 5i and 185W for the Aorus 16.

The 3DMark scores continue to tell an interesting story. The Flow Z13 scored 9,461 in TimeSpy and 21,026 in Fire Strike, lower than RTX 4060-based laptops like the Legion 5i (11,601 / 25,390) and Aorus 16 (11,351 / 24,494), but not dramatically so. Where the Z13's APU does fall short is ray tracing.

In the Port Royale test, it managed a 3,428, whereas the RTX 4060 laptops crossed the 6,000 mark, highlighting a clear gap in real-time ray tracing. But when it comes to actual gaming,